Australian Sound Design Project Interactive Map and Website CD launch

Ros Bandt
Australian Sound Design Project.
The Australian Centre
The University of Melbourne
137 Barry St
Carlton 3053
Australia
www.sounddesign.unimelb.edu.au
r.bandt@unimelb.edu.au

Abstract

The Melbourne City recently commissioned the Australian Sound Design Project to document soundoing artworks in Melbourne's CBD. Ros Bandt and Iain Mott documented the following works and arranged them on an interactive map for ease of access for the City. A cross platform CD of the website including this new map is being launched nationally at this national computer music event.

Introduction

THE AUSTRALIAN SOUND DESIGN PROJECT: UPDATE

The Australian Sound Design Project continues to lead the University of Melbourne in pioneering sound research and making it audible online. The site has been showcased and exhibited as one of the University's most innovative projects in annual design innovation fests. It has appeared in publications as an example of innovative sound research.

During 2006-7 the website has grown to include 147 works in its online digital gallery, with 98,478 hits on the site during the year. Most activity was from Australia followed by the Netherlands, Japan, France and the USA Educational. The faculty of Arts awarded Dr Ros Bandt the excellence for research Award for 2006 which featured this innovative digital publishing along with her other books, writings and original sounding artworks.

City of Melbourne Collaboration and Commission

The Australian Sound Design has completed a major new commission for the Melbourne City Council publishing seventeen new sound works that fall under their custodianship. These include, a) newly commissioned public sound works, b) works from the Council's collection and c) works in the Melbourne CBD. The online publication will encourage sound to be recognised as an important part of cultural heritage. Iain Mott and Ros Bandt documented the works on site and liaised with the artists to publish the works in image, sound video and text. Iain Mott developed an interactive map as a portal to these works. You can see the works in site on a map of the City of Melbourne and zoom in to the detailed documentation directly for each work.

Browse works on map of Melbourne. At

http://www.sounddesign.unimelb.edu.au/site/worldkit/index.html

Be sure to go to the digital gallery for each site.
The 17 CBD works newly documented are

Birrarung Wilam 2006-
City Talking 2006
Federation Bells 2002-
Lie of the Land 1997-
Life Coach 2006-2007
Musical Decking 2002
No Answer 2006-2007
Proximities2006-
Reeds 2000
Rice Paddies 2001
Scar-A Stolen Vision 2001
Southgate Soundscape 1992-2006
Spine 1.2 2006
Transient Frequencies
Tilly Aston Bell 1999-
Wall Piano 2002
Weather Harp 2003-2006

The Interactive Map was designed by Iain Mott using worldkit and an aerial map supplied by the Melbourne City Council. Red Circles are used to locate the fifteen works which are currently audible and red squares for the two decommissioned works for which we have documentation. This is an important archival facility as well as an information portal for visiting current works. By using the zoom buttons, one can travel down to see the position of the work in the site. By clicking on the red circles and squares you can navigate to the full documentation of each work directly seeing images, reading artist's statements and listening to the sound and watching videos.

All features of the search engines of the sound design site can be accessed for cross referencing by date, work, artist, site, title, location, stylistic feature.

This map is now being used in subjects at the Australian Centre *Australia Now* and for the VCA *Sound Art in the Environment at the Centre for ideas*.

Research and Development of the ASDP Site

In 2006 the site was recommended for inclusion in the National Research Network for Data Sustainability. At the University of Melbourne, Gavan McCarthy—director of Austehc and the team who invented the OHRM data archival methodology—is now using the ASDP site data to trial innovative aspects of the newest upgrade of the OHRM. The site is currently being reconfigured in OHRM 5 sponsored by Austehc.

In 2004-5 the National Library mined the site data for its lasting value through its *Music Australia* project, contributing $6000 to have the information transposed into a meta-data compatible format with the National Library system.

Credits

I would like to thank the City of Melbourne and the Australian Centre at the University of Melbourne for facilitating this work and especially am indebted to my former research assistant, Iain Mott who has worked tirelessly to produce the map and accompany me on the bicycle route to carry out the field work audio-visual documentation on site around the City of Melbourne over the past year.